KEY TAKEAWAYS:

- DevOps is the highest cost center ($16.26M total salary)
- 265 high-performing employees are underpaid relative to company median
- Finance shows the highest attrition risk (36.47% inactive)
- Regional pay-performance imbalance detected (Nevada has highest performance but lowest pay)
- Pending workforce pipeline bottlenecks in Cloud Tech (Texas) and Admin (New York)

KEY FINDINGS

Cost Center

- **DevOps** is the largest cost center, consuming **$16.26M** in salaries.
- Despite high costs, performance alignment is mixed — some senior DevOps employees underperform relative to pay.

Retention Risk

- **265 high performers** are paid **below** the company median, creating **a flight risk**.
- **Finance** and **Admin** departments show **attrition hotspots** with **>30% inactive employees**.

Performance-Pay Alignment

- **Average salaries** are fairly **consistent** across performance levels **(~$84K–$86K)**.
- However, **Excellent performers** are **NOT** significantly **better compensated** than Average performers, signaling **weak incentive structures**.

Diagnostic checks revealed 27 duplicate email entries across unique Employee IDs, suggesting a master-template error in the source system that requires an IT audit.

RECOMMENDATIONS

TOP 3 Issues

1. **Retention Risk:** Address underpaid high performers immediately to avoid losing critical talent.
2. **Attrition Hotspots:** Focus retention programs in Finance (36.47% inactive) and Admin (30.72% inactive).
3. **Pipeline Bottlenecks:** Resolve onboarding delays in Cloud Tech (Texas, 51.72% pending) and Admin (New York, 50% pending).

TOP 2 Opportunities

1. **Regional Pay Equity:** Nevada employees deliver the highest average performance (2.72) but earn the lowest average salary ($83.6K). Adjust pay to retain top talent.
2. **Seniority ROI:** Seniority level 5 employees show highest average performance (2.73) at moderate salaries. This group is a strong candidate for leadership development programs.